

Venturing into Indian Security and Surveillance Domain

Security and surveillance in offices and factories have become essential. The potential of the Indian market, along with the fast-evolving manufacturing ecosystem, motivated an Indian in the US to return and start manufacturing products in this segment. Despite ups and downs, he sidesteps all hurdles and moves on

■ VANISHA JOSEPH

After nine years of working in the US video surveillance industry, Bhupender Saharan wanted to return to India and manufacture products in this segment. Together with friends Vivek Bansal, Puneet Agarwal and J. Murali, he started Voice, Video, Data and Networking Technologies (VVDN) in April 2007. "Back then, no company designed, manufactured and developed camera solutions for security surveillance in India. Indian customers had to import such equipment. Our IP-camera solutions filled that gap," says Saharan, CEO, VVDN Technologies.

The company's IP cameras consist of a Freescale I.mx27 (VGA) or TI DM365 (megapixel) encoder, an image processor from Nethra Imaging and a sensor from Micron. "The high-quality image processor is used for stabilising the picture and removing bad pixels," says Saharan.

VVDN's first customer was a Gurgaon-based Internet service provider. "We offered them wide area network surveillance. This solution helped them monitor their offices across India, from Gurgaon," says Saharan.

Like most Indian manufacturers, VVDN Technologies did have initial hiccups. "The main problem was cost; imported cameras from Taiwan and Malaysia were cheaper. Our quality



Fig. 1: Video management system

was good, yet it was hard to convince customers about the value of our products over those of low-cost players," says Saharan.

An intelligent package

Realising that IP cameras alone wouldn't enable them to beat their competitors, VVDN launched smart video surveillance solutions in October 2007. "Our solutions went beyond video footage and offered smart video analytics like motion detection, people counting, object recognition, face recognition and perimeter protection. Any abnormalities would

raise an alarm," states Saharan.

The motion detector detects any kind of movement in a selected area. Face and object recognition allow one to feed pictures of people and raise alarms based on a predefined hot match. Perimeter protection fixes boundaries and detects any movement that breaks it. People-counting video analysis is used for data collection. About 14 software and hardware engineers have been working on it for one-and-a-half years.

Sidestepping the hurdles

VVDN Technologies still faces